

# Side-Income Plan

£5,000/yr recurring within 12 months — outside Hadley Bricks' core operation  
Chris Hadley · Prepared 10 June 2026 · Constraints: 10+ hrs/wk; no tooling that competes with HB's UK LEGO sourcing (adjacent niches/countries OK)  
Grounded by three market-research sweeps (10 Jun 2026): paid deal-alert tools, UK AI consulting rates, UK FIRE-tool gap

## 1 • Executive summary

Three tracks, deliberately diversified across certainty, recurrence and upside. The central case reaches ~£8.5k/yr by June 2027 — 1.7× target — and survives one full track failing.

| Track                             | Role                | 12-mo recurring £          | One line                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 • AI automation consulting      | The banker          | £3–7.5k                    | 2–3 fixed-scope gigs at £1.5–2.5k via warm network; rates and SME demand both verified       |
| 2 • Vinted Sniper, adjacent niche | The recurring core  | £3–5k                      | Port the existing engine to retro games or LEGO DE/FR; Whop+Discord at £12–15/mo; 30–40 subs |
| 3 • UK FIRE tool                  | The compounding bet | £1–3k (yr-2 upside £5–10k) | Productise the gilt-ladder/SWR engine built for our own plan; confirmed market gap           |

**The one caveat above all others** (every research thread converged on it): the bottleneck is selling, not building. The 20 warm-network conversations in weeks 1–2 are the highest-value hours in the plan.

## 2 • The full rated portfolio

Scores /10. Confidence = strength of market evidence. Burden = ongoing time once running (10 = near-zero).

| # | Idea                                                                     | 12-mo<br>£ | Confidence | Speed | Build | Burden | Risk | Verdict                                        |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------|-------|-------|--------|------|------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Fixed-scope AI automation gigs (UK SMEs, warm network)                   | £3–7.5k    | 9          | 9     | 9     | 6      | 8    | <b>DO — banker</b>                             |
| 2 | Vinted Sniper, adjacent niche (Whop, £12–15/mo, per-user filters)        | £3–5k      | 7          | 6     | 6     | 4      | 5    | <b>DO — recurring core</b>                     |
| 3 | UK FIRE tool — gilt ladder + CAPE-SWR + sequencer (freemium + affiliate) | £1–3k      | 6          | 4     | 7     | 7      | 6    | <b>DO — compounding bet</b>                    |
| 4 | Managed AI Instagram service for e-commerce (£300–500/mo/client)         | £3.6–6k    | 7          | 7     | 8     | 4      | 8    | <b>RESERVE</b> — swaps in if a track stalls    |
| 5 | LEGO retirement-radar newsletter + affiliate                             | £0.5–2k    | 5          | 3     | 7     | 6      | 8    | <b>LATER</b> — audience asset, not yr-1 earner |
| 6 | Templates / boilerplates / Claude-skill packs                            | £0.2–0.5k  | 3          | 5     | 8     | 9      | 9    | <b>SKIP — saturated, audience-dependent</b>    |

### 3 • Track 1 — AI automation consulting (the banker)

**Evidence:** UK freelance AI rates £400–800/day; UK AI contract median £550/day (IT Jobs Watch, 3,957 vacancies); 54% UK SME AI adoption in 2026 with 60% citing a skills gap (BCC/YouGov). £5k = 8–12 billable days/year. Offshore platforms do undifferentiated automations for £120 — which is why the channel is warm network, never Upwork.

**Positioning:** not "AI consultant" — *"I automate the back office of small product businesses — reconciliation, marketplace listings, social content — with systems I run in my own business."* The live demos (statement reconciliation, eBay/Amazon listing automation, the Instagram pipeline) are the differentiator, backed by a 20-year Accenture delivery CV.

| Published package (fixed price)                                              | Price  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| "Books that reconcile themselves" — bank/statement reconciliation automation | £1,800 |
| "Listings on autopilot" — marketplace listing/repricing automation           | £2,200 |
| "A month of content in an afternoon" — AI social pipeline setup + handover   | £1,500 |

**12-month shape:** two gigs (≈£3.5–4k); convert one into a £300–400/mo "keep it running" retainer where natural — that alone is £4k/yr recurring. Channels: Accenture alumni, local business owners, the reseller community (resellers are SMEs with exactly these problems).

## 4 · Track 2 — Sniper in an adjacent niche (the recurring core)

**Evidence:** generic Vinted monitors charge £25–35/mo and sell (VINTREZ: ~1,680 members in year one at €14.90; Fyndit, Souk, AutoFlipped comparable); Whop + Discord is the standard channel (~7% all-in fees); closest extension precedent is Closet Tools (Poshmark) at a self-reported \$42k/mo. Nobody found doing vision-ID + live margin calculation in the candidate niches. A free LEGO deal Discord (Brick Hound) holds 5,641 members; a US LEGO group (Brick Bucks) charges \$57/mo with weaker tooling.

### Niche selection (decide week 2)

| Candidate                            | Price reference         | Vision-ID              | Note                                              |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Retro/boxed video games UK</b>    | PriceCharting API       | Easy (title text)      | Strong flipper community — recommended first test |
| LEGO on Vinted DE/FR → Amazon.de/.fr | Keepa (same API)        | Zero work              | Easiest port; mild HB-overlap watch item          |
| Board games                          | BGG + eBay comps        | Easy (box art)         | Smaller flipper scene                             |
| Pokémon/TCG sealed                   | PriceCharting/TCGplayer | Moderate (sealed only) | Biggest market, most competition                  |

### Design decisions (from the research)

- **Alert-only, no autobuy** — Vinted's DataDome anti-bot partnership (Apr 2025) and the reported Feb 2026 ban wave make autobuy the liability tier; alert-plus-human-buys is the defensible side.
- **Per-user private filters/channels** — shared feeds cannibalise deals and drive churn (the established tools all solve this the same way).
- **£12–15/mo on Whop**, 7-day trial — deliberately under the £25–35 incumbents while offering more intelligence.
- **Costs:** Keepa API €49/mo + vision API + proxies ≈ £80–100/mo at scale; net ≈ £3–4.5k/yr at 30–40 subs.

**12-month shape:** port (3–4 wks) → 5-user free beta in one community (4 wks) → Whop launch month 3 → 30–40 subs by months 9–12. **Kill criterion:** <15 subs at month 6 → sunset, redirect hours to the reserve track.

## 5 · Track 3 — the UK FIRE tool (the compounding bet)

**Evidence of the gap:** no UK CAPE-conditioned SWR tool exists anywhere; nothing integrates gilt ladders + SWR simulation + ISA/SIPP/allowance sequencing; the free incumbents (LateGenXer's Streamlit ladder builder, YieldGimp) are hobby-grade — cold-starts, no saved plans, no couples. **Evidence of the moment:** HL gilt trading +315% YoY with 25k+ clients holding gilts and record retail volumes (Feb 2025); r/FIREUK at 313k members (+14%/yr); Monevator paywalls its gilt-ladder spreadsheet at £3–8/mo — direct proof this audience pays for this exact content. US analogue: ProjectionLab, solo founder, \$10k MRR.

**Product:** productise the engine already built for our own retirement plan — live-yield ILG ladder builder, the 155-year CAPE-SWR simulator, the wrapper-sequencing map. **Free:** single ladder, no save. **Paid (£4–6/mo or £39/yr):** saved plans, couples, scenarios, tax-sequencing report. **Affiliate:** ii/HL programmes

pay £200–400/funded account — every ladder session naturally ends at "you need a broker that deals gilts"; 15–25 referrals/yr hits the target by itself.

**FCA discipline:** outputs framed as mathematical optimisation of user-specified constraints; education-only disclaimers; no steering to specific securities on specific platforms; affiliate links at platform level, never rung level. One-off legal sanity check (~£1–2k) before charging — funded from Track 1 proceeds. Precedent: LateGenXer, YieldGimp and EvolveMyRetirement all operate unauthorised with disclaimers; the FCA's 2026 "targeted support" reforms signal a friendlier climate for guidance-shaped tools.

**12-month shape:** free ladder tool live months 2–3 (the code exists — this is packaging) → build in public on r/FIREUK and Monevator comments → paywall + affiliates months 4–6 → £1–3k year 1, with the year-2 adviser-tier upside (Timeline charges advisers ~£400/seat/yr) as the reason it earns the slot.

## 6 • 90-day execution sequence (10 hrs/wk)

| Weeks | Track 1 — consulting                                                      | Track 2 — sniper-adjacent                                     | Track 3 — FIRE tool                                         |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1–2   | One-page offer + 3 packages; list 20 warm contacts; first 5 conversations | Pick niche (test demand in 2 target Discords/FB groups)       | Domain + skeleton; port ladder builder to public page       |
| 3–6   | First gig sold / delivering                                               | Port engine (price API + vision prompt); recruit 5 beta users | Free ladder tool live; first r/FIREUK feedback post         |
| 7–10  | Deliver; ask for referral + retainer                                      | Whop store live £12/mo, 7-day trial; beta → paid              | CAPE-SWR simulator added; affiliate applications            |
| 11–13 | Gig 2 outreach                                                            | Marketing cadence: 1 post/wk in niche communities             | Paywall features (saved plans, couples); legal check booked |

**Review gates:** month 3 — any track with zero traction gets one diagnosis-and-fix cycle. Month 6 — kill/keep: sniper <15 subs = kill; FIRE tool <500 users = free-only mothball; consulting <1 gig = channel rethink, swap in the Instagram-service reserve.

## 7 • Risks and honest caveats

| # | Risk                                                                                                                                            | Treatment                                                                                                                                          |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Selling, not building, is the bottleneck</b> — unanimous across all three research sweeps                                                    | Plan front-loads 20 outreach conversations before any new code beyond the niche port                                                               |
| 2 | <b>Sniper sits on ToS-violating access</b> (Vinted prohibits automation; DataDome escalation real; no legal shutdowns found, but ban waves are) | Alert-only, browser-side, per-user; treat revenue as a 2–4 year window, not forever; month-6 kill gate                                             |
| 3 | <b>Cannibalisation drift</b> — LEGO-EU port leaks sourcing intelligence faster than retro games would                                           | Niche choice criterion; retro games recommended first                                                                                              |
| 4 | <b>FIRE tool revenue least certain</b> (frugal audience anchored on free)                                                                       | In the portfolio for asymmetry and fit, not certainty; affiliates may out-earn subscriptions                                                       |
| 5 | <b>Tax &amp; admin</b>                                                                                                                          | Lands on self-assessment atop HB profits; Whop/LemonSqueezy act as merchant-of-record for EU VAT; keep income lines separate from HB in the books  |
| 6 | <b>Unverified research items</b>                                                                                                                | r/legoinvest size (Reddit blocked), Monevator subscriber counts, self-reported revenues (ShipFast, Closet Tools) — none load-bearing for the maths |

## 8 • The arithmetic of hitting £5k recurring

| Scenario at June 2027 | Consulting     | Sniper          | FIRE tool | Total                                |
|-----------------------|----------------|-----------------|-----------|--------------------------------------|
| All low-end           | £1.5k (1 gig)  | £2.2k (15 subs) | £0.5k     | £4.2k — reserve track covers the gap |
| <b>Central</b>        | £3.5k (2 gigs) | £3.5k (28 subs) | £1.5k     | <b>£8.5k — 1.7× target</b>           |
| Retainer lands        | £4k recurring  | £4.5k           | £2k       | £10.5k recurring                     |

*Prepared 10 June 2026 by Claude with Chris Hadley. Working copy: Docs/side-income-plan-2026-06.md (finance-tracker repo). Research: three agent reports, 10 Jun 2026 — paid deal-alert market (Whop/Discord pricing, Vinted enforcement), UK AI consulting benchmarks (IT Jobs Watch, BCC/YouGov SME data), UK FIRE-tool gap (competitor table, HL gilt-demand data, FCA guidance boundary). Related: Docs/investment-plan-2026-06.pdf — Track 3 monetises its engine.*